Dharreo Phanit

Resource Identifier: CULT-FEST-006

English Translation: Pre-Harvest Blessing Festival

Category: Festival | Subcategory: Agricultural

Village / Region: Ukhrul / Phungcham | Dialect: Standard Tangkhul

Contributor / Source: Tangkhul Farming Elders (Traditional Observation (Horam 1977, Hodson 1911))

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Seasonal Timing / Occasion: October (Autumn pre-harvest blessing)

Ethnographic Summary & Context:

Autumn pre-harvest festival celebrated in October before sickle touches the golden grain. Ritual invocations petition the Creator for protection against devastating wind, hail, and vermin before harvest.

Indigenous Tangkhul Text / Chants / Sayings:

"Dharreo phanitli luisang kashung, kacham kashiman malailaka."

"Phungcham Ukhrul luishang kachivali Varewui ningli khorumda."

"Kazingmasho kazingmei makhavai, Varewui kakhon kaphali shitsang."

English Translation & Meaning:

"At Dharreo festival, the golden paddy stands ripe before harvest begins."

"Across Ukhrul and Phungcham, every family petitions the Almighty Creator for blessing."

"Praying for protection against storm, wind, and hail, that the grain may be safely reaped."

Procedural Sequence / Observance Steps:

1. Inspection of standing paddy fields by farming elders in late October.
2. Proclamation of Dharreo festival before any household strikes the sickle.
3. Morning prayers offered at the edge of terraced paddies invoking divine protection.
4. Household preparation of special roasted rice and brewed beverages for workers.
5. Reaping commences in disciplined solidarity across all village sectors.

Ceremonial Participants & Roles:

Farming Elders, Family Lineages, Reaping Teams